👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · US History · Unit 1 BASIC cartoon handout

New pieces for Levels 1, 2 and 3. L1 = about 2nd-grade reading with emoji and pictures. L2 = about 3rd-grade reading. L3 = close to the class work (guided notes and readings, no slide decks). Every lesson opens with the 5-minute review in the class plan.

1. What each piece goes with

Class lesson / piece	Our files	Notes
BASIC skills handout (partner reading + 10 questions)	L1/L2/L3 BASIC handout + keys + read-aloud page	Fills our 🚧 item “BASIC handout.” Our own explanation; practice with two public-domain cartoons (Franklin 1754; Nast 1871 at L3).

2. Supports built in

- L1: read aloud; picture choices; pointing counts.
- L2: word banks; 3 choices; no 'all of the above.'
- L3: class questions with short answers; no slide decks.

3. What to grade

- Complete = full credit, or 1 point per item.
- These are modifications. Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

4. Who to ask

- The SLE teacher: changes and IEP questions.
- Facts we could not confirm say “check with the class teacher”.

Picture credits

Benjamin Franklin - Join or Die.jpg · Benjamin Franklin · Public domain · Wikimedia Commons
Nast-Boss-Tweed-1871.jpg · Harper & Brothers; illustration by Thomas Nast · Public domain · Wikimedia Commons

👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · US History · Unit 1 Timeline & Political Cartoons (Level 3)

Level 3 = resource-room students who can work close to the gen ed lesson. No slide decks: students follow Ms. Stockmar's lesson and slides with Level 3 readings, guided notes and a quick check.

1. How the pieces line up

Gen ed lesson	Level 3 piece
Her readings and worksheets	Level 3 reading (5 short paragraphs) + check questions
Class notes	Level 3 guided notes + key
Unit quiz / test	Level 3 quick check + key
Review (Kahoot / Jeopardy)	1 Level 3 game on the class site: 10 questions + a matching round

2. Supports built in

- 🔊 Read aloud on the reading and notes pages (tap the button)
- Key terms listed at the top of the notes
- Short-answer lines sized for 1-2 sentences

3. What to grade

- Notes and reading checks: same points as her worksheets for that lesson
- Quick check: score, then scale to her test points
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

4. Who to ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE): changes and IEP questions.
- Facts we could not confirm say “check with Ms. Stockmar”.

🚧 Under construction (check with Ms. Stockmar)

- **BASIC handout**: Her BASIC handout is not in the export. We used Background, Argument, Symbols, Indicators, Caricature from her warm-up and exit questions.

💗 Sensitive topic note

Her timeline slides include assassinations, 9/11 and the Kent State shootings. Our pieces list only the calm anchor dates; staff can pause before those slides in the class power point.

👩🏾‍🏫 Staff Guide · US History · Unit 1 Timeline & Cartoons: Day by Day

3 class days in the order the class teaches them. Each day has a Level 1, 2 and 3 daily notes sheet (warm-up = the 5-minute review, notes, exit ticket), a key and a read-aloud page. Use the daily sheet next to the class lesson; the unit's slides, guided notes, quizzes and games are still on the unit page.

Day	Lesson	Warm-up	Class activity (what the class does)	Exit ticket
Day 1	Timeline Activity	A timeline puts events in…	Build the class U.S. History timeline; correct the timeline worksheet; begin the social contract.	Which came first?
Day 2	Timeline Debrief and Class Contract	To understand a political cartoon, first look for…	Timeline debrief with a partner; complete the social contract; timeline activity quiz.	Chronological order means…
Day 3	BASIC Cartoons	Background knowledge means…	BASIC skills worksheet (use our batch-1 BASIC handout at L1-L3); practice with cartoons of the decades; 25th anniversary of 9/11 resources.	In B.A.S.I.C., the S stands for…

Supports

- L1: about 2nd-grade reading, emoji and pictures; 2 picture choices; read every line aloud; pointing counts.
- L2: about 3rd-grade reading; word bank in every notes box; 3 choices.
- L3: close to the class work: guided notes and short answers.

Grading and help

- Daily notes: complete = the class daily points (logs/warm-up + exit).
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows; check with the case manager.
- The SLE teacher: changes and IEP questions. Facts we could not confirm say “check with the class teacher”.

🗓️ Timeline & Political Cartoons: Guided Notes

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Timeline Events in US History + BASIC cartoon analysis

Name: _____

Use the class slides and your reading. Key words:

timeline *chronological* *primary source* *political cartoon* *background* *argument* *symbol* *indicator* *caricature*

A. Timeline (Timeline Events activity)

1. Events listed from oldest to newest are in _____ order.

2. Fill in the table.

Event	Year	Why it matters
Civil War ends		
Women win the vote		
Stock market crash		

3. Pick one event on her timeline you did not know. What happened, and why is it important?

B. BASIC (cartoon analysis)

4. A cartoon made at the time it describes is a _____ source.

5. Exaggerating a person's features is called _____.

6. Use BASIC on Nast's Boss Tweed cartoon. What is the symbol, and what is the argument?

7. Why were cartoons a powerful way to reach voters in the 1870s?

🗓️ Day 1: Timeline Activity: Daily Notes

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · Timeline & Cartoons

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: Key events in U.S. history and our class expectations.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. A timeline puts events in…

_____

Key terms: 1776 · 1918 · 2001 · Civil War · Depression

📝 Guided notes

1. In _____ the colonies declared independence.
2. The _____ (1861-1865) ended slavery in the U.S.
3. World War I was from 1914 to _____.
4. The Great _____ began in 1929.
5. On September 11, _____, terrorists attacked the U.S.
6. World War II ended in _____.
7. The Civil Rights Act was passed in _____.

✍️ Analyze

1. Why is it important to know these events from the timeline?

_____

_____

_____

🎟️ Exit ticket

1. Which came first?

A. September 11	B. World War I	C. The Declaration of Independence

2. List 3 events from the last 20 years that should be added to the timeline.

_____

_____

🗓️ Day 2: Timeline Debrief and Class Contract: Daily Notes

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · Timeline & Cartoons

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: The order of key 20th-century events and our class contract.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. To understand a political cartoon, first look for…

_____

Key terms: Chronological · Civil Rights · immigration · social contract · vote

📝 Guided notes

1. _____ order means time order, oldest to newest.
2. About 1900: _____ and factories grew.
3. In 1920 women won the right to _____.
4. In the 1950s-60s the _____ Movement fought for equal rights.
5. A _____ is an agreement about how we treat each other.
6. An _____ is a long period of time with shared events.
7. B.C.E./C.E. and decades like the _____ name parts of time.

✍️ Analyze

1. Write one rule for our class contract and why it matters.

_____

_____

_____

🎟️ Exit ticket

1. Chronological order means…

A. size order | B. ABC order | C. time order

2. Which era are you most interested in studying? Why?

_____

_____

🗓️ Day 3: BASIC Cartoons: Daily Notes

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · Timeline & Cartoons

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: How to use B.A.S.I.C. to read political cartoons.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. Background knowledge means…

_____

Key terms: Argument · Background · Caricature · Indicators · Symbols

📝 Guided notes

1. B = _____: what was going on at the time?
2. A = _____: what is the artist's message?
3. S = _____: what do the pictures stand for?
4. I = _____: what do the words and labels say?
5. C = _____: what is drawn too big on purpose?
6. Political cartoons are on the _____ (opinion) page.
7. Uncle Sam is a _____ for the United States.

✍️ Analyze

1. Use BASIC on one cartoon. What is its argument?

_____

_____

_____

🎟️ Exit ticket

1. In B.A.S.I.C., the S stands for…

A. Spaghetti | B. Sun | C. Symbols

2. What does B.A.S.I.C. stand for?

_____

_____

🗓️ Timeline & Political Cartoons: Reading

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Timeline Events in US History + BASIC cartoon analysis

Name: _____

Reading the Past: Timelines and Political Cartoons

Historians put events on a timeline so we can see what came first and what came later. Order matters: one event often causes the next. For example, the Civil War ended in 1865, and the years after it shaped how the country grew west.

This year we study about 1865 to the 1930s. In that time the United States moved west, took in millions of immigrants, became an industrial nation, fought in World War I, gave women the vote in 1920 and fell into the Great Depression after the 1929 stock market crash.

A political cartoon is a drawing about news, government or society. It is not meant to be fair. It shows the cartoonist's opinion and tries to persuade the reader. Cartoons made at the time are primary sources: they show what some people thought back then.

Our class uses BASIC to read cartoons. Background: what do you already know about the event? Argument: what does the artist want you to believe? Symbols: what do the pictures stand for? Indicators: what do the words, labels and captions tell you? Caricature: what is exaggerated?

In 1871 Thomas Nast drew New York politician Boss Tweed with a bag of money for a head. The caricature and the money-bag symbol make one clear argument: Tweed was greedy and corrupt. Readers who could not read well could still understand the message.

Check your reading

1. Why do historians care about the order of events?

2. Why is a political cartoon not a neutral source?

3. Name the five parts of BASIC.

🗓️ Timeline & Cartoons: BASIC Cartoon Handout

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · how to read a political cartoon

Name: _____

Use BASIC on every political cartoon this year.

B.A.S.I.C. in your own words

1. B (Background): How does background knowledge help a person understand a political cartoon?

2. Why is it harder to understand cartoons from the 1800s than today's cartoons?

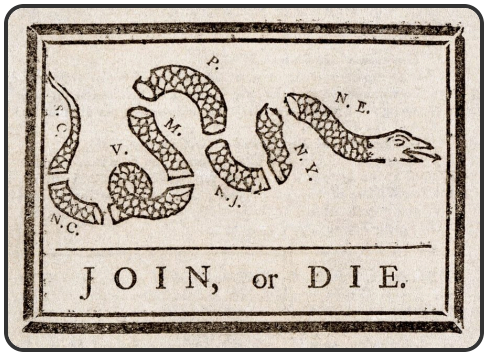
3. A (Argument): What is the goal of a political cartoon? Where in a newspaper do you find them, and why not in the comics section?

4. S (Symbols): How are symbols used? List 3 symbols most Americans would recognize.

5. I (Indicators): Where can you find indicators, and why read all of them?

6. C (Caricature): Why is caricature used? Why are stereotypes in old cartoons a problem?

Practice 1: Join, or Die (1754)

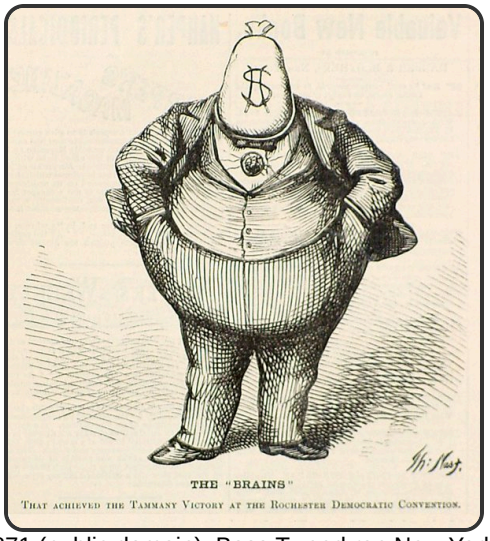


“Join, or Die.” Benjamin Franklin, 1754 (public domain)

7. Fill in the table.

B	A	S	I	C

Practice 2: The “Brains” (1871)



“The ‘Brains.’” Thomas Nast, 1871 (public domain). Boss Tweed ran New York City politics and stole millions.

8. Fill in the table.

B	A	S	I	C

🗓️ Timeline & Political Cartoons: Quick Check

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Timeline Events in US History + BASIC cartoon analysis

Name: _____

Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

1. Which list is in chronological order?

A. 1920, 1865, 1969, 1903 | B. 1969, 1920, 1903, 1865 | C. 1865, 1903, 1920, 1969

2. A political cartoon is best described as…

A. An opinion in picture form | B. A neutral news photo | C. A government report

3. In BASIC, “indicators” are…

A. Exaggerated features | B. The artist's opinion | C. Words, labels and captions

4. Uncle Sam in a cartoon is an example of…

A. A symbol | B. A caption | C. A date

5. Explain why a cartoon from 1871 is a primary source.

6. What is the difference between a symbol and a caricature?

🗓️ Timeline & Political Cartoons: Guided Notes · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Timeline Events in US History + BASIC cartoon analysis

Name: _____

Use the class slides and your reading. Key words:

timeline *chronological* *primary source* *political cartoon* *background* *argument* *symbol* *indicator* *caricature*

A. Timeline (Timeline Events activity)

1. Events listed from oldest to newest are in **chronological** order.

2. Fill in the table.

Event	Year	Why it matters
Civil War ends	**1865**	**Country reunites; Reconstruction and westward growth**
Women win the vote	**1920**	**19th Amendment doubles the voters**
Stock market crash	**1929**	**Starts the Great Depression**

3. Pick one event on her timeline you did not know. What happened, and why is it important?
Answers vary: event + year + one reason it matters.

B. BASIC (cartoon analysis)

4. A cartoon made at the time it describes is a **primary** source.

5. Exaggerating a person's features is called **caricature**.

6. Use BASIC on Nast's Boss Tweed cartoon. What is the symbol, and what is the argument?
Symbol: the money bag for a head. Argument: Tweed is greedy and corrupt.

7. Why were cartoons a powerful way to reach voters in the 1870s?
Many people could not read well; a picture makes the point quickly.

🔑 *Key written by our team from Ms. Stockmar's worksheets and slides, please check.*

🗓️ Day 1: Timeline Activity: Daily Notes · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · Timeline & Cartoons

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: Key events in U.S. history and our class expectations.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. A timeline puts events in…
order by date

Key terms: 1776 · 1918 · 2001 · Civil War · Depression

📝 Guided notes

1. In **1776** the colonies declared independence.
2. The **Civil War** (1861-1865) ended slavery in the U.S.
3. World War I was from 1914 to **1918**.
4. The Great **Depression** began in 1929.
5. On September 11, **2001**, terrorists attacked the U.S.
6. World War II ended in **1945**.
7. The Civil Rights Act was passed in **1964**.

✍️ Analyze

1. Why is it important to know these events from the timeline?
They explain how the country got to today; past events shape laws, rights and choices now.

🎟️ Exit ticket

1. Which came first?

A. September 11	B. World War I	**C. The Declaration of Independence**

2. List 3 events from the last 20 years that should be added to the timeline.
Examples: COVID-19 pandemic (2020), first Black president elected (2008), smartphones, major elections.

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*

🗓️ Day 2: Timeline Debrief and Class Contract: Daily Notes · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · Timeline & Cartoons

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: The order of key 20th-century events and our class contract.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. To understand a political cartoon, first look for…
clues like labels and symbols

Key terms: Chronological · Civil Rights · immigration · social contract · vote

📝 Guided notes

1. **Chronological** order means time order, oldest to newest.
2. About 1900: **immigration** and factories grew.
3. In 1920 women won the right to **vote**.
4. In the 1950s-60s the **Civil Rights** Movement fought for equal rights.
5. A **social contract** is an agreement about how we treat each other.
6. An **era** is a long period of time with shared events.
7. B.C.E./C.E. and decades like the **1920s** name parts of time.

✍️ Analyze

1. Write one rule for our class contract and why it matters.
Any respectful rule with a reason.

🎟️ Exit ticket

1. Chronological order means…

A. size order | B. ABC order | **C. time order**

2. Which era are you most interested in studying? Why?
Names an era with a reason.

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*

🗓️ Day 3: BASIC Cartoons: Daily Notes · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · Timeline & Cartoons

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: How to use B.A.S.I.C. to read political cartoons.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. Background knowledge means…
what I already know about the time

Key terms: Argument · Background · Caricature · Indicators · Symbols

📝 Guided notes

1. B = **Background**: what was going on at the time?
2. A = **Argument**: what is the artist's message?
3. S = **Symbols**: what do the pictures stand for?
4. I = **Indicators**: what do the words and labels say?
5. C = **Caricature**: what is drawn too big on purpose?
6. Political cartoons are on the **editorial** (opinion) page.
7. Uncle Sam is a **symbol** for the United States.

✍️ Analyze

1. Use BASIC on one cartoon. What is its argument?
Names a cartoon and gives its message using at least one clue.

🎟️ Exit ticket

1. In B.A.S.I.C., the S stands for…

A. Spaghetti | B. Sun | **C. Symbols**

2. What does B.A.S.I.C. stand for?
Background, Argument, Symbols, Indicators, Caricature.

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*

🗓️ Timeline & Cartoons: BASIC Cartoon Handout · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · how to read a political cartoon

Name: _____

Use BASIC on every political cartoon this year.

B.A.S.I.C. in your own words

1. B (Background): How does background knowledge help a person understand a political cartoon?
You need to know the events and people of the time to get the joke or point.

2. Why is it harder to understand cartoons from the 1800s than today's cartoons?
We do not know the people, events and symbols of that time as well.

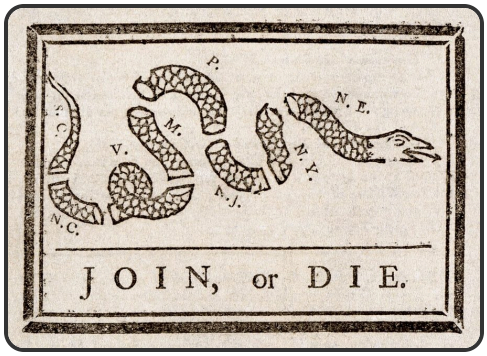
3. A (Argument): What is the goal of a political cartoon? Where in a newspaper do you find them, and why not in the comics section?
To persuade / give an opinion on an issue. On the editorial (opinion) page, because they are opinions, not just jokes.

4. S (Symbols): How are symbols used? List 3 symbols most Americans would recognize.
A picture stands for a bigger idea. Uncle Sam/eagle = USA, donkey/elephant = parties, dove = peace, $ = money.

5. I (Indicators): Where can you find indicators, and why read all of them?
Titles, labels, captions, speech bubbles. They tell who and what is shown, so you don't miss the point.

6. C (Caricature): Why is caricature used? Why are stereotypes in old cartoons a problem?
Exaggeration makes the point stronger. Stereotypes treat a whole group unfairly; many old cartoons were racist or cruel.

Practice 1: Join, or Die (1754)

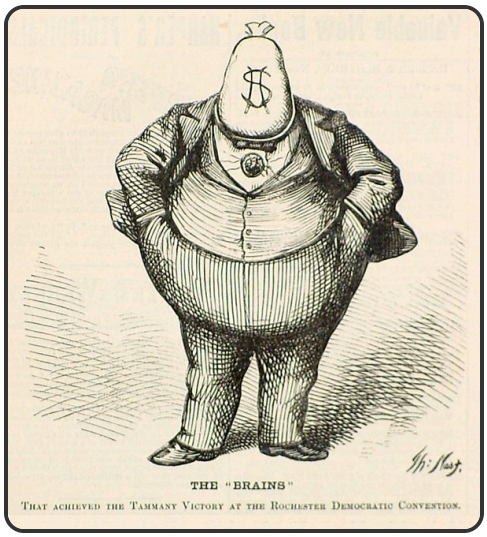


"Join, or Die." Benjamin Franklin, 1754 (public domain)

7. Fill in the table.

B	A	S	I	C
French and Indian War is starting; Franklin wants colonies to unite (Albany Plan)	**Unite or be destroyed**	**Cut-up snake = divided colonies**	**Colony initials; "JOIN, or DIE."**	**None really: the snake is a symbol, not a caricature**

Practice 2: The “Brains” (1871)



“The ‘Brains.’” Thomas Nast, 1871 (public domain). Boss Tweed ran New York City politics and stole millions.

8. Fill in the table.

B	A	S	I	C
Boss Tweed and Tammany Hall controlled NYC and stole millions	**Tweed's power comes from money and corruption**	**Moneybag for a head = his “brains” are money**	**Dollar sign; the caption about the Tammany victory**	**Huge belly and tiny head = greed**

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*

🗓️ Timeline & Political Cartoons: Quick Check · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Timeline Events in US History + BASIC cartoon analysis

Name: _____

Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

1. Which list is in chronological order?

A. 1920, 1865, 1969, 1903 | B. 1969, 1920, 1903, 1865 | **C. 1865, 1903, 1920, 1969**

2. A political cartoon is best described as…

A. An opinion in picture form | B. A neutral news photo | C. A government report

3. In BASIC, “indicators” are…

A. Exaggerated features | B. The artist's opinion | **C. Words, labels and captions**

4. Uncle Sam in a cartoon is an example of…

A. A symbol | B. A caption | C. A date

5. Explain why a cartoon from 1871 is a primary source.

It was created during the time it describes, so it shows views from then.

6. What is the difference between a symbol and a caricature?

A symbol stands for an idea; a caricature exaggerates a real person's features.

🔑 *Written by our team from her timeline activity, BASIC questions and warm-ups, please check.*